of the missing planks, he fell into the torrent below. His desperate shouts for help resulted in many Chinese soldiers switching on their flashlights, thereby exposing their positions. Bikram Singh fired a Very light, at which point all the Kumaonis opened fire. Delta Company, supported by mortars and MMGs, turned the tables on the Chinese who were caught unawares at the narrow fording point. It was estimated that at least seventy Chinese soldiers were killed or wounded, while Delta Company had three killed, one wounded and one missing, presumed dead. An hour later, Madiah told Bikram Singh to break contact and fall back on Walong.

On their return, 6 Kumaon had deployed at Walong. 4 Sikh's Battalion HQ had been established on the West Ridge. Alpha Company commanded by Major P. M. Samvatsar was at Dakota Hill; Charlie Company under Major Sandhu was deployed on the High Plateau while Bravo Company commanded by Major Harbans Singh was holding Maha Plateau with one platoon at Mithun. Delta Company under the command of Major Malik was deployed at Lachhman Ridge, while the battalion mortars were on the reverse slope of Dakota Hill. In addition, two platoons of 2/8 GR had been pushed north to cover The Ladders, while a third platoon was at Maha Plateau with Bravo Company of 4 Sikh. A second Gorkha company was deployed on the East Bank under the command of Madiah. The two wings of the Assam Rifles were patrolling the flanks of the sector.

By the evening, news had filtered in that Lieutenant General Harbaksh Singh had taken over IV Corps from the ailing Bijji Kaul. The officers and men of 4 Sikh in particular were extremely upbeat, for Harbaksh Singh was their Colonel of the Regiment. The new brigade commander, Brigadier Hartley, too was from the Sikh Regiment, which meant that the battalion would be that much more under the scanner. Even though no one in Walong was aware of the full extent of the disaster that had befallen 7 Infantry Brigade, there was a general sense of relief that Bijji Kaul would not be leading them into battle.

Ever since Delta Company's successful engagement at Ashi Hill, the Chinese had been lurking behind it, and they continued to fire at Mithun and the Maha Plateau from there. Two Chinese jitter parties had probed the Walong defences without much success. During the night of 26-27 October, the Chinese launched a determined attack on the Mithun track. The Sikhs were waiting for them and they cut down the advancing enemy with accurate rifle fire. However, the Chinese, desperate for some success in the